

IMAGINED STUDENT COMMENTS

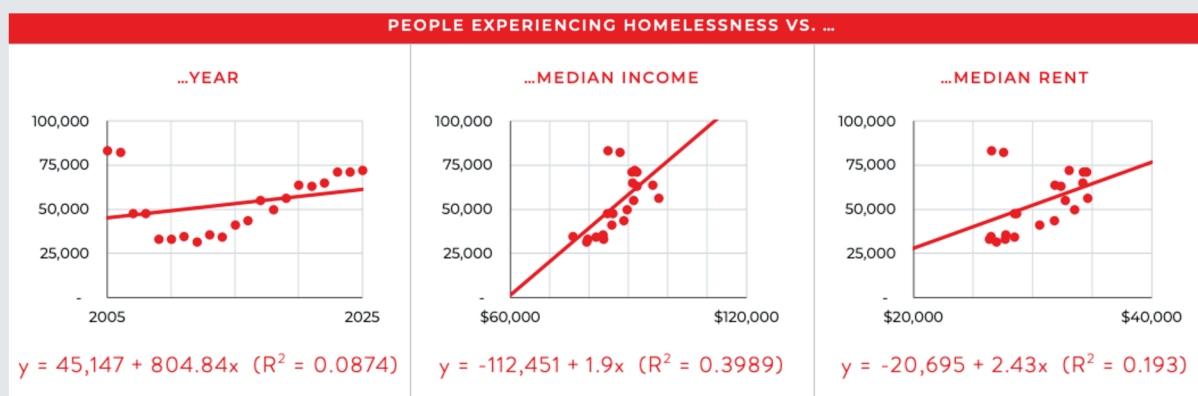
It's valuable and important that students connect their learning to real-world issues that matter. But it can also feel a little risky: What if my students (or I!) say "the wrong thing" and someone gets hurt?

Below are some comments that one teacher feared might come up during the Citizen Math lesson Seeking Shelter in which students interpret linear models of data to explore what influences homelessness.

EXCERPT FROM QUESTION 3

At any given moment in the United States, there are more than 700,000 people experiencing homelessness. Many of these people become homeless when they could no longer afford to pay their rent. Watch the video about some of these people.

Next, look at the graphs below, and describe the story they tell about homelessness in Los Angeles from 2005 to 2025. Would you conclude that there's a strong relationship between how expensive a city is and how many people experience homelessness there?



When median income rose, the landlords raised rent which caused homelessness to rise, too. ...Ugh, landlords are so greedy!

Why are we talking about homelessness when we don't even have homeless people in our town?

What is "rent" anyway? All I know is that my dad says buying a house is always a better investment than renting.

Are we supposed to talk about this in math class?

As rents rose, so did homelessness – because those people couldn't afford rent anymore. But why not just get a second job...or move to a cheaper place instead of sleeping on the streets?